Christians, led to Edward's acting as financial agent for the American Mission at Tabriz and Urumia. He tutored the Prince's children and had charge of the royal stables. He did odd jobs of translating into Turkish and Persian, both languages of which he had acquired a fluent knowledge. Thus, while continuing to be held officially responsible with his brother, and confined to the general neighborhood of the town of Tabriz, he managed to spend his days not too unpleasantly. His letters abound in the names and events which have brought Asia Minor into the western limelight; many of his references are of prime historical importance not only in regard to the matter discussed, but also the actors involved, with most of whom he had personal acquaintance. Thus, revealing bits of information are afforded us by the retailing of incidents concerning such great names as Rawlinson and Layard, the fathers of Assyriology, or of the inner workings of the British and Russian embassies.

In 1848 Edward's link with the royal house was greatly strengthened by the accession to the throne of Nasir i Din, nephew of the now exiled Bahman Mirza. Edward sold everything he could lay his hands on and joined the triumphal march from Tabriz to Teheran, where he was immediately appointed chief interpreter and later made editor of the state gazette. His most pressing personal concerns were now relieved, for although still technically a debtor, the change in government and the lapse of time had so altered his status that he was practically free to do as he pleased. By this time, however, the East had entered into his soul and the thought of returning to a mercantile existence in England was so repugnant that he cemented his ties in Persia by refusing the offer of a position in America (secured for him by his younger brother George), and finally, in 1852, by his marriage to a beautiful Armenian girl. And so, although most of his career had been shadowed by the meteoric rise and fall of his brother Charles, and although that shadow was only dispelled at the very end of his life, Persia came to mean the *summum bonum* of his existence. One small cloud remained; for a long time he was unable to secure leave to return to England for a visit. Ironically, when he finally did wring *official* permission from the government to leave the country for that visit, he died en route, still in Persia.

## THE LETTERS *

[CHARLES BURGESS TO HIS PARENTS] *Smirna, March 10, 1828*

I am afraid you will think I have let slip a very long time without writing but since my last our affairs wore such a gloomy and uncertain aspect that I had no

* NOTE: The letters are arranged chronologically as follows: To and from Charles Burgess; to and from Edward Burgess. Letters relating to either brother, though not part of their correspondence, are inserted in their chronological places.

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